

Amanda Johnson

Adjunct Instructor • Marketing Strategist • Former NBC News Producer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Educator, executive advisor and former television journalist with more than 20 years of experience spanning marketing, strategic communications, entrepreneurship and executive leadership. Over the past two decades, I have helped founders, CEOs, Fortune 500 organizations and nonprofit leaders translate strategy into action through marketing, communications, executive advising and organizational leadership. My career has included leadership roles at NBC News, L'Oréal, Omnicom Media Group and Here Media, as well as consulting for organizations including American Express, Visa, Nestlé, Toyota, Eli Lilly, Novartis and Gilead. Today, I combine executive practice with teaching, designing experiential learning that helps students and leaders strengthen communication, judgment and decision-making in an AI-enabled world.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Instructor

Cupcakes + Broccoli LLC

Education company focused on entrepreneurship, AI and strategic decision-making.

October 2018 - Present

Moore, SC

- Founder and lead educational programming focused on entrepreneurship, AI, communications and strategic decision-making.
- Developed and teach original curriculum on entrepreneurship, leadership, marketing and AI through workshops, executive education programs and discussion-based learning experiences.
- Design and facilitate workshops, seminars and executive learning experiences for entrepreneurs, professionals and nonprofit leaders.
- Created *The Decision Room*, an executive learning community where founders and senior leaders develop decision-making capabilities through discussion-based case learning.
- Advise founders on market positioning, growth strategy, business model development and executive decision-making while mentoring entrepreneurs through business and career transitions.

Adjunct Instructor (Faculty Pool)

Benedict College, Harold L. Burroughs School of Business

July 2026 – Present

Columbia, SC

- Appointed to the adjunct faculty pool within the Harold L. Burroughs School of Business to teach business and marketing courses.
- Prepare students to think strategically and communicate effectively by combining academic theory with real-world business cases, discussion-based learning and practical application drawn from current industry challenges.
- Foster critical thinking and ethical decision-making in an AI-enabled world, emphasizing discernment, sound judgment and the ability to evaluate information rather than simply generate it.
- Draw on corporate leadership, executive consulting and entrepreneurship experience to help students develop the professional skills, confidence and adaptability needed to succeed in today's business landscape.

Insight Developer Consultant

Agency Mania Solutions

Industry leader in agency relationship management software for Fortune 500 organizations.

January 2023 – February 2026

Moore, SC (Remote)

- Synthesized qualitative and quantitative data from global marketing organizations, identifying patterns across client-agency relationships and translating complex findings into strategic recommendations for organizations including American Express, Toyota, Nestlé and Eli Lilly. Leveraged AI selectively to accelerate analysis where client policies permitted.
- Translated agency and client feedback into strategic recommendations that informed marketing strategy, communications, procurement decisions and executive decision-making.
- Designed executive workshops, presentations and decision frameworks that helped senior leaders communicate strategy and navigate complex organizational decisions.
- Crafted executive narratives, thought leadership and presentation materials that enabled client teams to communicate complex business challenges with clarity and confidence.

Global Vice President, Digital Marketing

L'Oréal

Global beauty company that moves the world through science, innovation and technology.

April 2016 – June 2018

New York, NY

- Educated more than 2,000 marketing professionals across 40+ countries through keynote presentations, workshops and executive education programs.
- Led global digital strategy for the Matrix Professional brand, developing digital marketing frameworks adopted across more than 40 international markets.
- Partnered with global education teams to strengthen digital marketing capabilities, advising regional leaders on social media, influencer marketing, content strategy and consumer engagement.
- Established global digital standards, governance and brand guidelines to ensure consistent consumer experiences across websites, social platforms and digital campaigns while enabling local market adaptation.
- Directed global content strategy spanning B2B education for professional hairstylists and consumer-facing campaigns, collaborating with product marketing, education, creative and business development teams.
- Oversaw agency selection, production partners and digital vendors, improving content quality, speed-to-market and operational efficiency through strategic procurement and vendor management.
- Delivered keynote presentations and executive education programs to marketing leaders representing more than 40 countries, translating emerging digital trends into practical business strategies.

Vice President, Integrated Marketing

Here Media (*Publisher of Out Magazine, The Advocate, Here TV and HIV Plus*)

Leading LGBTQ+ media company creating editorial, digital, television and live experiences for consumers and advertisers.

June 2013 – March 2016

New York, NY

- Promoted from Director to Vice President, leading integrated marketing strategy for national advertisers across print, digital, video, experiential marketing and branded content.
- Generated more than \$3.5 million in sponsorship revenue by developing strategic partnerships with brands including Lexus, American Express, Macy's, AT&T, MassMutual, Ketel One and Barefoot Wine.
- Produced the annual Out100 Gala, a premier recognition event honoring influential LGBTQ+ leaders, managing sponsor activations, executive stakeholders and event production for more than 300 guests while supporting nonprofit partners including the Trevor Project and GMHC.
- Conceived and produced American Express' "#ExpressYourSelfie" small business campaign, creating integrated marketing experiences across Pride celebrations in multiple U.S. cities to promote LGBTQ+ entrepreneurs.
- Developed integrated marketing programs that aligned advertiser objectives with editorial storytelling across print, digital and live experiences while maintaining editorial integrity.
- Served as the strategic bridge between advertising, editorial and executive leadership, translating client objectives into innovative campaigns that generated business value while strengthening audience engagement.

Associate Producer

NBC News (NBCUniversal)

Global news organization delivering fact-based journalism across broadcast, digital and streaming platforms.

August 2005 – May 2011

New York, NY

- Produced news packages, promotional content and affiliate-ready broadcast materials for more than 150 NBC television stations nationwide, extending the reach of NBC Nightly News through localized storytelling.
- Wrote, produced and edited broadcast segments, raw video packages and promotional assets that translated national news into relevant local content for affiliate newsrooms.
- Served as the primary liaison between NBC News and local affiliate stations, gathering editorial feedback, identifying regional story angles and representing affiliate perspectives during NBC Nightly News editorial meetings.
- Managed satellite media tours featuring Brian Williams and NBC News correspondents, coordinating live interviews between network talent and local television stations nationwide.
- Collaborated with producers, editors, satellite operations and control room staff to deliver accurate deadline-driven journalism while overseeing live broadcast logistics.
- Covered the 2008 U.S. presidential campaign, traveling with the campaign of John McCain and producing affiliate coverage from campaign events and the vice-presidential debate.
- Selected for the highly competitive NBC News Associates Program, rotating across NBC Nightly News, TODAY and MSNBC.

Global Management Supervisor, Business Development**Omnicom Media Group (OMG)**

Global media and marketing services company representing many of the world's leading brands.

June 2011 – May 2012

New York, NY

- Developed persuasive pitch presentations and executive narratives supporting multimillion-dollar media planning and buying opportunities with global advertisers.
- Translated market research, consumer insights and emerging trends in digital media, social media and programmatic advertising into compelling client stories.
- Created and managed an internal thought leadership website distributed across Omnicom Media Group, publishing industry analysis, media trends and case studies from teams throughout the global organization.
- Partnered with senior leaders across strategy, media, analytics and client services to communicate agency capabilities and position Omnicom as a trusted strategic partner.

Senior Director, Creative Development**The Tyra Banks Company**

Media and consumer products company developing new business ventures, strategic partnerships and technology-driven brand experiences.

June 2012 – May 2013

New York, NY

- Served as Chief of Staff-style strategic advisor to Tyra Banks, translating executive vision into cross-functional initiatives spanning beauty, technology, partnerships and new ventures.
- Led business planning for a Tyra-branded beauty venture, collaborating with licensing consultants to define the brand strategy, product positioning and licensing approach.
- Evaluated new venture and product opportunities, conducting market validation, competitive analysis and business model assessment to inform executive investment decisions.
- Directed cross-functional development and launch of an augmented reality mobile application, partnering with software developers and Apple while leading the product marketing strategy.
- Served as Tyra's business liaison for the annual T-Ball Gala, translating executive vision into operational execution while coordinating with the event production team to support a multimillion-dollar fundraising event benefiting the Lower Eastside Girls Club.

Associate Producer**News 10 Now Spectrum News**

24-hour local television news station serving Central New York.

January 2005 – June 2005

Syracuse, NY

- Wrote broadcast copy, assigned reporters, monitored police scanners and coordinated daily local news coverage.
- Managed digital updates for the station website, publishing breaking news, streaming video and photography.

EDUCATION**Master of Business Administration in Marketing (MBA)****New York University Leonard N. Stern School of Business**

2008 – 2011

New York, NY

Master of Science in Broadcast Journalism (MS)**Syracuse University S. I. Newhouse School of Public Communications**

2004 – 2005

Syracuse, NY

Bachelor of Science in Industrial Engineering and Operations Research (BS)**Cornell University College of Engineering**

2000 – 2004

Ithaca, NY

LEADERSHIP, RECOGNITION & PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Keynote Speaker, L'Oréal Professional Global Conference

Speaker, AdTech Summit (Tel Aviv, Israel)

SXSW Interactive Panelist

Selected for the competitive NBC News Associates Program

Carl T. Rowan Project Excellence Scholar, Cornell University

Selected for NASA Goddard's Women in Science and Engineering (WISE) Summer Research Program

Completed MBA through the General Electric Tuition Reimbursement Program while employed by NBCUniversal

Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc. — Greenville (SC) Alumnae Chapter; initiated Mu Gamma Chapter, Cornell University (Spring 2003)
National Association of Black Journalists
Mosaic

CORE COMPETENCIES

Executive Education • Entrepreneurship • Strategic Communications • Marketing Strategy • Executive Communications • Leadership Development • Organizational Leadership • Strategic Decision-Making • Curriculum Development • Experiential Learning • Executive Facilitation • Startup & Founder Advisory • Consumer Behavior • Brand Management • Digital Marketing • AI in Business & Media • Public Speaking

STUDENT MENTORSHIP

Mentor undergraduate students, graduate students, entrepreneurs and early-career professionals through coaching and career advising.

Guide students in professional communication, interviewing, networking and career development.

Design experiential learning opportunities that connect classroom concepts with current industry practice.

COURSES PREPARED TO TEACH

Journalism, Media & Communications

Mass Communication • Journalism • Broadcast Journalism • Media Writing • Digital Journalism • Public Relations • Strategic Communications • Digital Media • Media Literacy • Storytelling • Content Creation • Social Media Strategy • Public Speaking • Professional Communication • Branding & Reputation Management • Communication Leadership • AI Applications in Media & Communications

Business & Marketing

Principles of Marketing • Consumer Behavior • Marketing Strategy • Brand Management • Digital Marketing • Integrated Marketing Communications • Marketing Research • Marketing Analytics • Advertising & Promotion • Content Marketing • Social Media Marketing • E-Commerce Marketing • Entrepreneurship • Introduction to Business • Professional Development & Career Readiness • AI Applications in Business

TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

At the center of my teaching philosophy is a simple belief: in an age where information is abundant, judgment is becoming the most valuable skill students can develop. Whether students pursue careers in business, journalism, communications or entrepreneurship, they will be asked to solve complex problems, evaluate competing perspectives and make decisions that influence organizations and communities. My goal is to help them develop confidence and discernment to do so thoughtfully and ethically.

As artificial intelligence transforms every profession, students will have unprecedented access to information. They will be able to generate business plans, marketing campaigns, articles, presentations and competitive analyses in seconds. Information is becoming abundant. Discernment is becoming valuable. The professionals who thrive will not simply produce information more quickly. They will ask better questions, recognize meaningful patterns, verify information and exercise sound judgment before taking action.

That belief shapes how I teach. My classroom emphasizes discussion, current events, case studies and collaborative problem-solving rather than memorization. Drawing on experience in journalism, marketing, executive leadership and entrepreneurship, I help students connect theory with real-world practice while evaluating the opportunities and limitations of artificial intelligence. My goal is not simply to prepare students for their first job, but to help them become thoughtful decision-makers whose judgment earns trust, creates opportunity and enables them to lead with confidence throughout their careers.

EXECUTIVE EDUCATION & WORKSHOPS

Design and facilitate executive workshops on entrepreneurship, AI, strategic communications, marketing and leadership for founders, nonprofit organizations and business leaders.

Facilitate The Decision Room, a discussion-based executive learning experience where founders and senior leaders strengthen strategic thinking and decision-making through real-world business cases.

Develop experiential learning programs that translate current business challenges into practical frameworks for leadership, communication and organizational decision-making.

INSTRUCTIONAL TECHNOLOGIES

Microsoft 365 • Google Workspace • Canvas • Blackboard • Zoom • ChatGPT • Claude • Gemini • PowerPoint